Sales Performance Reporting: Business Requirements Document

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1. Project Overview

The sales team of a retail superstore reviews performance through manual Excel pivots. This is slow, hard to repeat and does not show where money is being lost. This project replaces that with a SQL-based analysis and an interactive Power BI dashboard.

Dataset: Sample Superstore (9,994 order lines; fields include Sales, Quantity, Discount and Profit)
Tools: SQL (SQLite), Power BI Desktop

2. Stakeholders (mock)

Stakeholder	Role	Main need
Sales Head	Decision maker	See which products and discounts lose money
Regional Manager	Dashboard user	Track the performance of their own region
Finance Analyst	Reviewer	Report revenue and growth trends
Business Analyst (Swati)	Author	Gather requirements, build and validate the solution

3. Business Problem

- Leadership does not know which sub-categories lose money.
- Discounts are given without checking their effect on profit.
- Monthly reports are built manually in Excel, so they are slow and error-prone.

4. Objectives

1 Show total sales, profit and profit margin at a glance.
2 Identify loss-making products and sub-categories.
3 Measure how discount levels affect profit.
4 Give managers a dashboard they can filter by region and category.
5 Recommend an action based on the findings.

5. Scope

In scope: data quality checks, SQL analysis, a Power BI dashboard with KPIs and filters, and a recommendation.
Out of scope: live data refresh from a company system, forecasting, customer-level targeting.

6. Business Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority (MoSCoW)
BR-01	Show total sales and total profit	Must
BR-02	Show profit margin %	Must
BR-03	Show profit by sub-category	Must
BR-04	Highlight loss-making sub-categories in red	Must
BR-05	Show profit by discount band	Must
BR-06	Filter the dashboard by region	Must
BR-07	Filter the dashboard by category	Should

ID	Requirement	Priority (MoSCoW)
BR-08	Show monthly sales and profit trend	Should
BR-09	Show year-over-year sales growth	Should
BR-10	Show total orders and average order value	Should
BR-11	Show top 10 customers by sales	Could
BR-12	Show segment-wise performance (Consumer, Corporate, Home Office)	Could
BR-13	Data must be checked for duplicates and missing values	Must
BR-14	Dashboard must open and respond in under 5 seconds	Should
BR-15	Dashboard must be refreshable from the source file	Should

7. User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

US-01: As a Sales Head, I want to see profit by sub-category so that I can identify loss-making products.
Acceptance criteria: All 17 sub-categories are shown; sub-categories with negative profit appear in red; values match the SQL results.

US-02: As a Sales Head, I want to see profit by discount band so that I can decide a discount limit.
Acceptance criteria: Four bands are shown (0%, 1-20%, 21-40%, 40%+); negative bands appear below zero; totals match the SQL results.

US-03: As a Regional Manager, I want to filter by region so that I can track my team's performance.
Acceptance criteria: Selecting a region updates all cards and charts; clearing the filter restores the full view.

US-04: As a Finance Analyst, I want to see total sales and total profit so that I can report headline results.
Acceptance criteria: The sales card shows about 2.30M and the profit card shows about 286.40K, matching the source data.

8. Data Requirements

Field	Use
Order Date, Ship Date	Time trends (read as US month/day/year)
Region, State, City	Geographic filters
Category, Sub-Category	Product analysis
Sales, Quantity, Discount, Profit	KPIs and discount analysis

Data quality rules: no missing Sales, Profit or Discount values; no duplicate order lines; numeric fields stored as numbers; dates stored as dates.

9. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Usability:** a manager with no technical skills can use the filters.
- **Accuracy:** every dashboard figure must match the SQL result.
- **Performance:** the dashboard loads in under 5 seconds.
- **Maintainability:** SQL queries are saved in one file, and the Power BI file is version controlled on GitHub.

10. Assumptions and Constraints

- The Superstore data is treated as the company's complete sales history.
- Currency is as given in the dataset; no conversion is applied.
- Stakeholders are simulated for this case study.

11. Key Findings (from the analysis)

- Total sales are about 2.30M and total profit is about 286.4K.

- Three sub-categories lose money: **Tables (-17,725), Bookcases (-3,473) and Supplies (-1,189)**, a combined loss of about 22.4K.
- Profit by discount band is shown in the table below.

Discount band	Order lines	Profit	Margin
0%	4,798	+320,988	29.5%
1-20%	3,803	+100,785	11.9%
21-40%	460	-35,817	-15.3%
40%+	933	-99,559	-77.4%

- Order lines with discounts above 20% are about 14% of all lines (1,393 of 9,994) but produce a combined loss of about 135K.

12. Recommendation

Cap discounts at 20% unless a manager approves an exception, and review pricing and discounting for Tables and Bookcases first. Supplies loses money at a low average discount, so its problem needs a separate cost and pricing review.

13. Success Measures

- Share of order lines with a discount above 20%.
- Profit margin before and after the discount cap (to be measured after the policy change).
- Time taken to produce the monthly sales report.

14. Sign-off (mock)

Name	Role	Date
[Sales Head]	Approver	
Swati Pandita	Business Analyst	